Legible Studio

Replacing paper plans in construction

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1. The problem

Every framing crew in residential construction still works off paper plans.

The drawings get rolled up, rained on, lost in the truck. The carpenter measures off them with a tape and a pencil, calls dimensions to a partner across the room, marks a line, walks back to the print, and starts over.

That workflow hasn't changed since the 1950s.

2. What we’re building

Two pieces that connect.

Legible Studio is the design software. Site constraints in — lot dimensions, setbacks, program, budget. Permit-ready drawings out. No walls drawn by hand. The designer’s job becomes review and judgment, not production.

LegiView is the hardware on the longer arc. Safety glasses worn for layout, tethered to the worker’s phone. The plan locks into the worker’s field of view, anchored to the building. They still pull out their tape — the tape is the tape — but they’re not fighting paper anymore.

Same underlying data flows through both. The structured plan from Legible becomes the spatial overlay in LegiView. One product line, two surfaces, one data layer underneath.

3. Why now

Three things matured in the last two years and they're matching up.

Constraint-satisfaction solvers got fast enough to handle real building code at interactive speeds. Foundation models can read building code documents and reason about them. Consumer AR hardware crossed the threshold where a $349 dev kit does visual-inertial tracking that used to require a $30,000 robotic total station.

Nobody's standing at the intersection of all three for residential construction. Trimble has the workflow but not the form factor. Autodesk has the software but not the field. Magic Leap had the hardware but not the construction. The intersection is empty.

4. Why me

I've lived all four corners of this problem.

Computer Science degree. Advanced diploma in Architectural Technology. Ten years on construction sites, building houses with my hands. Currently running AndOr Designs, a residential design-build company in Ontario, and teaching architectural technology at a college.

That's the unfair advantage. I write the code, I draw the architectural drawings, I pour the concrete, and I teach the next generation how to do it. Most people in AEC tech have one or two of those. I have all four.

5. Proof of execution

I ship hard things alone, fast.

In the last two months I wrote a Rust kernel from scratch. It boots, has its own crypto and TLS stack, makes real HTTPS calls to the Anthropic API, and runs a live Claude tool-use agent loop end to end — currently in QEMU, with the ThinkPad bare-metal target as the next phase. 150+ boot-time tests passing. I built it to prove to myself what I'm capable of executing alone before asking anyone else to bet on me.

The Legible constraint solver works today. The structured-plan pipeline runs. The Revit export bridge is in motion.

This isn't a pitch deck about something I might build. It's a pitch deck about something I've already started.

6. Traction

AndOr Designs is the first customer and the first design partner. Every Legible feature gets validated against AndOr's actual permit checklist before it ships.

Three to five additional pilot design-build firms are within reach in the Ontario market. The municipal inspector channel is a parallel exploration — building inspectors are an underserved category with regulatory tailwind and clean ROI economics.

7. The market

North American residential construction is a multi-trillion-dollar industry. Permit-set production is a chokepoint on every project — every house, every renovation, every addition needs them.

Ontario is the beachhead. The Ontario Building Code is the rules engine's first domain. From there, the rules engine extends jurisdiction by jurisdiction: Quebec, then BC, then Washington, then California. The architecture is jurisdiction-agnostic; the data is what makes it real.

The long arc is owning the structured spatial record of every building Legible touches — the data layer that sits underneath layout, inspection, and as-builts. That's the platform thesis.

8. The team

Founder (me) — full-time, vision, code, customer relationships, the whole thing today.

Founding partner / COO — full-time hire, starts month two. Comfortable across all the relationships: customers, vendors, hires, ODM partners, municipalities. Cash plus equity. Profile: someone who's run operations at a small physical-product company and is ready for the next chapter.

Engineer 1 — month six. Rust core, constraint solver, rules engine.

Hardware engineer — month six. Has shipped consumer AR or wearables through an ODM before. Owns the v1 hardware program.

Engineer 2 — month fourteen. iOS, AR, Revit bridge.

Five people by end of year two.

9. The ask

$1.6 million USD pre-seed. 24-month runway.

What it buys:

- Full Ontario Building Code Part 9 rules engine, end to end.
- Five paying software customers.
- A working v0.5 prototype of LegiView in the hands of 10 workers across 5 sites, with measured productivity improvement.
- The Series A pitch told with evidence, not promises.

The Series A in month twenty-two is $10 to 15 million USD, raised on the strength of the field data and the paying customer base built in this round.

10. Contact

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logo concept 3j

Based in Ontario, Canada. Open to in-person in Toronto or by video for anywhere else.